MIDORA

MVP Home Feed Strategy
0 to 199 Eligible Listings

Products • Services • Opportunities

Scope

This is the detailed implementation specification for Midora before formal exploration quotas, personalisation, complex behavioural ranking or pay-to-win ranking exist. It covers the Home feed, discovery pathways, freshness, seller fairness, Premium Shops, monetised extra listings, fallback, empty lanes, calculations, loopholes, tests and growth triggers.

MVP rule: circulate honest supply before optimising winners.

1. The MVP decision

Do not use 60/25/15 as a quota from zero to 199

For 0–199 eligible listings, the Home feed should mostly reflect the qualified supply Midora actually has. Midora may gently correct domination by one listing type, seller or subcategory, but the application should not manufacture a 12/5/3 block when the underlying marketplace cannot support it.

MVP question	Decision
Home ratio	Dynamic supply-led ratio. No fixed Product/Service/Opportunity quota. Apply only gentle diversity steering.
Block size	20-card planning window where at least 20 eligible unique cards exist; return fewer honestly when fewer exist.
Exploration quota	None from 0–199. Fair exposure is delivered through freshness, unseen-first circulation and seller variety.
Personalisation	Off.
Behavioural ranking	Off except collection of events for future use.
Paid ranking	Off. Extra listing capacity may be monetised; distribution is not guaranteed.
Premium	Better shop tools/capacity/presentation, same organic card eligibility.
Repetition	Do not repeat a listing within an active feed session until all eligible alternatives for that context are exhausted.

2. Why a fixed ratio is wrong at MVP

Suppose Midora has 100 eligible listings: 70 Products, 20 Services and 10 Opportunities. The natural supply shares are:

```
Product share     = 70 ÷ 100 = 70%
Service share     = 20 ÷ 100 = 20%
Opportunity share = 10 ÷ 100 = 10%
```

Forcing 60/25/15 would demand 5 more Services and 5 more Opportunities per 100 impressions than the qualified inventory naturally supplies. With only 10 Opportunities, Midora would either repeat the same Opportunities too often, lower quality, or hide good Products. All three are bad.

MVP ratio rule

Use observed qualified supply as the starting ratio, then cap obvious domination rather than force an ideal ratio. A future 60/25/15 target becomes relevant only when each lane has enough unique inventory to support repeated 20-card blocks without recycling.

Gentle type balancing formula

```
supplyShare[type] = eligibleTypeCount / totalEligibleCount

MVP targetShare[type] = clamp(
    supplyShare[type],
    minimumPresence[type],
    maximumPresence[type]
)

Suggested Home guardrails when all three types exist:
Product maximum ≈ 80%
Service maximum ≈ 50%
Opportunity maximum ≈ 35%

These are configurable guardrails, NOT quotas.
```

Minimum presence should not create content. If one good Opportunity exists, place it once in the session. Do not “reserve” three Opportunity slots.

3. Inventory stages inside the MVP

Eligible listings	Home-feed behaviour	Why
0	No listing feed. Show demand capture and seller acquisition modules.	There is nothing honest to rank.
1–19	Show all eligible cards with freshness + quality + seller variety. No 20-card padding.	Every card needs exposure.
20–49	20-card blocks; unseen-first; seller spacing; type and subcategory anti-clumping.	Ranking competition is still weak.
50–99	Same core logic; add stronger exposure balancing so recently shown cards do not monopolise the first block.	Some cards can now become buried.
100–199	Use stronger quality/freshness ranking plus exposure penalty, but still no formal exploration slot.	Enough inventory exists for ranking to matter, but dedicated exploration is premature.

Critical stage gate

Do not move to the 200+ strategy merely because the database contains 200 rows. Count only active, unique, non-expired, available, quality-passing listings. Also check type depth and seller depth.

4. Day-zero Home: what appears with zero listings

- Category navigation: Products, Services, Opportunities.
- “Be the first to list” seller call-to-action.
- “Tell Midora what you need” demand request.
- Location selector so demand can be mapped by Kampala, Wakiso, Mukono and future supported areas.
- Notify-me / saved need for unavailable categories.
- Invite-a-seller or recommend-a-business action.
- A transparent message that listings are being added, rather than dummy or fake inventory.

Zero-listing leak to avoid

Do not seed fake cards, fake views, fake sellers or pretend “popular” listings. Cold-start credibility is more valuable than artificial abundance. If Midora creates editorial launch content, label it honestly and do not mix it with seller inventory as though it were organic.

5. MVP Home feed pipeline

```
REQUEST HOME
  ↓
1. Load ACTIVE candidate inventory
  ↓
2. Hard eligibility filter
  ↓
3. Deduplicate
  ↓
4. Calculate quality score
  ↓
5. Calculate freshness score
  ↓
6. Calculate exposure penalty / unseen bonus
  ↓
7. Calculate MVP organic score
  ↓
8. Sort candidates
  ↓
9. Placement pass
   ├─ seller spacing
   ├─ type anti-clumping
   ├─ subcategory anti-clumping
   └─ session no-repeat
  ↓
10. Fill up to 20
  ↓
11. Governed fallback if a soft rule blocks supply
  ↓
12. Return cards + cursor + placement reasons
  ↓
13. Count impression only when actually viewed
```

Hard eligibility filter

Rule	MVP requirement	Fallback may relax?
Status	Active/published only.	No
Expiry/deadline	Not expired or closed.	No
Availability	Product available; Service active; Opportunity open.	No
Moderation	Not blocked or flagged beyond allowed threshold.	No
Minimum completeness	Required fields for the listing type present.	No
Duplicate	Canonical listing only.	No
Seller standing	Seller account active.	No

Quality score

```
Example QualityScore (0–100), configurable by type
Products:     media 30 + title/description 20 + price 20 + location 15 + availability/contact 15
Services:     media/portfolio 20 + clear service 25 + service area 20 + pricing/quote clarity 15 +
availability/contact 20
Opportunities: clear role/opportunity 25 + organisation/contact 20 + location 15 + deadline 15 + requirements 15 +
application method 10
```

These are starting weights. The important design principle is that each listing type may use a different quality rubric while producing a comparable 0–100 score.

6. Freshness: show new cards without burying the best cards

Freshness is not “newest wins”

A fresh listing receives a temporary advantage, but quality remains strong enough that a poor new listing cannot automatically beat a very good older one.

```
MVP OrganicScore =
  45% QualityScore
+ 35% FreshnessScore
+ 20% ExposureScore

For 1–49 listings you may temporarily use 40% Quality + 45% Freshness + 15% Exposure because circulation matters more.
For 100–199 move toward 50% Quality + 30% Freshness + 20% Exposure.
All weights are stage configuration, not hard-coded constants.
```

Suggested freshness decay

Age since publish / meaningful update	Freshness score
0–6 hours	100
6–24 hours	90
1–2 days	75
3–4 days	60
5–7 days	45
8–14 days	30
15–30 days	15
31+ days	5, provided listing is still valid

```
Piecewise implementation example:
FreshnessScore = lookup(ageBand)

A smoother alternative later:
FreshnessScore = 100 × exp(-ageDays / halfLifeParameter)

Use a longer half-life for Services and a deadline-aware function for Opportunities.
```

Meaningful update and anti-repost rules

- Store originalPublishedAt, lastMeaningfulUpdateAt and lastMinorEditAt separately.
- Fixing spelling, opening the edit screen or changing one word must NOT refresh freshness.
- Possible meaningful changes: material price change, new availability, new meaningful photos, real description expansion, changed Opportunity deadline, significant scope change.
- Apply a refresh cooldown, for example no more than one freshness reset within 72 hours at MVP. Make the value configurable.
- Deleting and recreating a substantially identical listing should inherit the earlier freshness history where duplicate matching is confident.

7. Fair exposure without formal Exploration

Below 200 listings, Midora does not need dedicated Exploration slots. Instead, the organic score includes an ExposureScore and the placement engine prefers unseen eligible cards.

```
Example ExposureScore (0–100):
0 qualified impressions in last 7 days       = 100
1–2                                           = 80
3–5                                           = 60
```

```
6–10                                        = 40
11–20                                       = 20
21+                                         = 5

Qualified impression = card entered viewport, for example ≥50% visible for ≥1 second.
```

Important

ExposureScore protects quiet good cards. QualityScore protects the feed from weak cards. FreshnessScore keeps the marketplace alive. The three signals solve different problems.

8. Worked calculation: building a 20-card block

Assume 80 eligible listings: 48 Products, 22 Services and 10 Opportunities, from 30 sellers.

```
Supply shares:
Products      48/80 = 60.0%
Services      22/80 = 27.5%
Opportunities 10/80 = 12.5%

For 20 positions, a natural composition is approximately:
Products      20 × .60  = 12
Services      20 × .275 = 5.5 → about 5–6
Opportunities 20 × .125 = 2.5 → about 2–3
```

This happens to look close to 60/25/15, but it comes from actual qualified supply. If supply changes to 80/15/5, the Home feed should not fake 60/25/15.

Candidate	Quality	Freshness	Exposure	Calculation	Organic score
New good phone	82	100	100	.45×82 + .35×100 + .20×100	91.9
Excellent older service	96	45	100	.45×96 + .35×45 + .20×100	78.95
Average new product	60	100	100	.45×60 + .35×100 + .20×100	82.0
Excellent well-shown product	95	75	20	.45×95 + .35×75 + .20×20	73.0

Notice the caution: the average new Product scores 82 and can beat the excellent older Service at 78.95. If this happens too often, freshness is too strong. The team should calibrate weights using real outcomes. A sensible safeguard is a quality floor for the first block, for example QualityScore ≥65 where supply permits.

Placement after ranking

```
For each next position:
1. Take highest remaining candidate.
2. If already shown in session → skip for this session.
3. If same seller was just shown → hold candidate and try the next one.
4. If feed has a visible run of one type/subcategory → try next strong alternative.
5. Place candidate.
6. Update seller/type/subcategory counters.
7. Continue until 20 or no eligible candidate remains.
```

9. Type, seller and subcategory anti-clumping

Soft rule	Starting MVP setting	Reason
Same seller consecutively	Avoid.	Makes marketplace look like one seller's shop.
Seller cap in first 20	Target max 2 when seller depth supports it.	Promotes seller variety.
Seller cap in thin supply	Allow 3, then 4 only through fallback.	Do not create empty feed.
Type run	Avoid >4 same type consecutively if another qualified type exists.	Preserves mixed-marketplace feeling without quotas.
Same subcategory run	Avoid >3 consecutive if alternatives exist.	Prevents "all phones" feeling on Home.
Listing repetition	Never repeat within active session until available unique alternatives are exhausted.	False abundance harms trust.

Surface warning

These anti-clumping rules apply to Home. Search, Categories and Filters should follow the user's intent instead. A Phones category may legitimately contain 20 phones.

10. Next 20, sessions and recycling

- Block 1 selects up to 20 unique cards.
- Block 2 continues from remaining ranked candidates and held candidates. It does not restart at rank 1.
- Keep shownListingIds, seller counts for the current block, cursor positions and configuration version in the feed session.
- If 65 cards are eligible, the user can reach roughly 20 + 20 + 20 + 5 unique cards before recycling is considered.
- When the session expires, recompute ranking so genuinely new or meaningfully updated cards can enter near the front.
- If important new supply arrives during a long session, insert it at the next block boundary rather than reshuffling cards already displayed.

Governed fallback ladder

Step	If normal placement cannot fill the slot
1	Try next candidate satisfying all soft diversity rules.
2	Relax type anti-clumping.
3	Relax subcategory anti-clumping.
4	Relax seller minimum gap.
5	Relax seller 2-per-20 soft cap to 3, then 4 if inventory is extremely concentrated.
6	If all unseen unique candidates are exhausted, end the feed or explicitly enter a recycled state.
Never	Never relax safety, availability, expiry, hard filters, duplicate suppression or minimum quality/required fields.

Empty lane management

Situation	Correct behaviour
No Opportunities	Do not reserve Opportunity positions. Build Home from Products and Services.
Only 1 Service	Show the Service once when competitive/eligible; do not recycle it every 20 cards.
Only Products	Show Products honestly and make Services/Opportunities category CTAs visible as supply-building prompts.
One seller owns most supply	Use other sellers first where reasonable, then relax seller cap transparently through fallback rather than ending the feed.
Fewer than 20 total	Return fewer than 20. Never duplicate cards to make the screen look full.
A type has low-quality cards only	Do not lower quality simply to represent the type.

11. Discovery in the MVP

Discovery below 200 is not a special 2-card lane

Discovery comes from multiple routes: Home circulation, Search, Categories, Filters, seller/shop pages, fresh inventory insertion and demand-capture links. Formal algorithmic Exploration comes later.

Discovery surface	MVP rule
Home	Broad browsing: quality + freshness + exposure + soft diversity.
Search	Query relevance first; then availability, quality, location, trust and freshness. No Home ratio.
Categories	Stay inside selected category/type. Rank with quality + freshness; provide relevant filters.
Filters	Hard constraints. Never violate selected type, location, price, condition, deadline or other filter to “discover” something.
Shop page	Show that seller’s eligible inventory; seller diversity rules are irrelevant.
Zero-result state	Offer nearby/broader category or location only as an explicit user choice; capture notify-me demand.
Low-result state	Show exact matches first, then a clearly separated “You may also

	consider" expansion. Do not mix expansions into exact results silently.

12. Free sellers versus Premium Shops at MVP

Fundamental rule

Premium status must not secretly make an inferior listing organically outrank a stronger Free listing. Premium can monetise shop capacity, tools and presentation from the MVP without selling buyer relevance.

Capability	Free seller	Premium Shop
Organic Home eligibility	Yes	Yes, same ranking equation.
Search/category eligibility	Yes	Yes, same relevance requirements.
Active listing allowance	Base free allowance, configurable.	Higher allowance purchased with subscription.
Shop page	Basic seller profile/listings.	Branded storefront, collections, richer information and more management tools.
Analytics	Basic views/enquiries.	Richer listing/shop analytics.
Bulk tools	Limited/manual.	Bulk upload/edit, scheduled publish/renew later if built.
Verification	Evidence-based only.	Premium is not verification; never merge the two badges.
Guaranteed Home impressions	No	No.
Paid placement	Not in 0–199 MVP ranking. Can be introduced later with labels and caps.	Same rule.

Monetised extra listings

Charging a seller to publish more active listings is different from charging to rank higher. Midora can monetise capacity early without corrupting discovery.

```
Example capacity model, CONFIGURABLE and to be commercially tested:
Free seller:         first N active listings included
Extra-listing pack:  increases active listing allowance
Premium Shop:        larger active listing allowance + shop/analytics tools

IMPORTANT:
Purchased capacity changes how many listings may be active.
Purchased capacity does NOT add ranking points.
```

Fairness rule for sellers who buy extra capacity

- All paid extra listings enter the same eligibility and score pipeline as free listings.
- Seller-level Home caps prevent one large/Premium seller from consuming the whole feed merely because the seller can publish more.
- On the seller's own Shop page, all eligible listings can be shown because the user intentionally entered that shop.
- Search can return several listings from one seller if they are genuinely relevant, but add light seller diversification when many equivalent sellers exist.
- Do not advertise "more visibility" for extra listing capacity unless Midora can truthfully demonstrate that benefit. Sell it as capacity, not guaranteed impressions.

13. What NOT to monetise yet

- Do not sell permanent organic ranking bonuses.
- Do not sell unlabeled Sponsored positions.
- Do not promise a number of impressions without an impression-serving system and sufficient demand.
- Do not allow Premium badge to imply identity or trust verification.
- Do not sell Boost if the marketplace has too little buyer traffic to create meaningful incremental exposure.

When paid visibility can start

At 200+ qualified listings and healthy buyer traffic, Midora may test one clearly labelled Sponsored/Boosted position per 20, only if the card passes relevance and quality gates. This belongs to the next-stage strategy, not the 0–199 MVP.

14. Feed leaks, loopholes and abuse cases

Leak / loophole	How it hurts Midora	MVP control
Delete and repost	Seller continually regains freshness.	Duplicate history + original publication inheritance + refresh cooldown.
Tiny edits	Seller resets freshness without real value.	Meaningful-update classifier/rules.
Listing flooding	One seller buys/posts many near-identical cards.	Near-duplicate detection + seller Home cap.
Wrong type selection	Seller marks Product as Service to get visibility.	Type validation and moderation; category schema.
Keyword stuffing	Search manipulation.	Normalised titles, keyword abuse checks, relevance based on structured fields too.
Fake price 1 UGX	Gets filter attention.	Price plausibility checks; optional price-type fields such as negotiable/contact.
Expired Opportunity kept live	Bad trust and wasted user time.	Mandatory deadline/status; auto-close.
Premium badge confused with verified	False trust assumption.	Distinct visual and data semantics.
Impression inflation	Seller refreshes own cards repeatedly.	Deduplicate/discount self and suspicious repeated impressions.
Exposure-score gaming	Seller creates many new listings to get unseen bonus.	Seller concentration caps and duplicate controls.
Feed starvation	Too many soft caps leave fewer than 20 despite good inventory.	Ordered fallback ladder.
False abundance	Cards recycled too soon.	Unseen-first session logic and explicit end/recycle state.

15. Questions the developer and product owner must answer

- ☐ What exactly counts as one eligible “listing” for each type?
- ☐ Which required fields make a Product, Service or Opportunity quality-passing?
- ☐ How long is one feed session: browser session, 4 hours, 12 hours, one day?
- ☐ What geographic scope does Home use before a user chooses location?
- ☐ What is the free active-listing allowance at launch, and is it per seller, phone number, business or Shop?
- ☐ When a seller purchases extra listing capacity, when does unused capacity expire?
- ☐ How do we detect the same item reposted with a new listing ID?
- ☐ What counts as a meaningful update and which fields can refresh freshness?
- ☐ When does an Opportunity automatically close?
- ☐ What should happen to sold Products and temporarily unavailable Services?
- ☐ What minimum quality floor applies when supply is thin?
- ☐ Can one seller own both a Free profile and a Premium Shop? How is duplication prevented?
- ☐ When should the Home candidate pool refresh during a long scroll?
- ☐ How are impressions deduplicated for logged-out visitors?
- ☐ What demand events are stored from zero-result Search and empty Categories?

16. MVP acceptance tests

- ☐ 0 listings returns no fake feed cards and displays supply/demand CTAs.
- ☐ 7 listings returns at most 7 unique listing cards, not 20 duplicated cards.
- ☐ 30 listings can all be reached before normal recycling.
- ☐ 100 listings with 80 Products / 15 Services / 5 Opportunities does not force 60/25/15.
- ☐ A new low-quality listing cannot automatically outrank a high-quality older listing beyond configured safeguards.
- ☐ A meaningful price/photo/availability update may refresh freshness; spelling correction does not.
- ☐ Deleting and reposting the same item does not create unlimited freshness.
- ☐ A Premium listing and identical Free listing receive the same organic score if all listing signals are equal.
- ☐ A seller who buys 20 additional listing slots does not bypass seller caps in Home.
- ☐ Search “plumber Kampala” contains only relevant results; Home type balancing cannot inject Products.
- ☐ Filters remain hard constraints.
- ☐ Block 2 contains new candidates rather than restarting Block 1.
- ☐ A feed with no Opportunities fills from Products/Services without errors or blank reserved slots.
- ☐ Expired Opportunities, sold Products and unavailable/closed inventory do not return through fallback.
- ☐ Each Home card records why it was placed and its score/configuration version.

17. Data to collect now for the 200+ algorithm

Event / measure	Why collect it
Qualified impression	Measures real exposure and creates future exploration baseline.
Unique viewer impression	Separates repeated exposure from reach.
Detail open	Stronger interest than scrolling past.
WhatsApp/contact click	Potential commercial lead.
Apply click	Opportunity outcome signal.
Save/share	Intent signal.
Listing marked sold/closed	Lifecycle and potential conversion evidence.
Search query + zero results	Shows unmet demand.
Category/filter usage	Shows buyer intent before personalisation.
Seller response/activity where reliable	Future service quality and ranking signal.
Report/block	Negative trust and quality signal.

Do not use these signals in ranking too early

Collect clean data first. At 0–199, tiny sample sizes make click-based ranking unstable and easy to manipulate. These events prepare Midora for the 200+ stage.

18. Developer pseudocode

```
buildMvpHomeFeed(session, config):
    candidates = loadActiveInventory()
    candidates = hardEligibilityFilter(candidates)
    candidates = deduplicate(candidates)

    for listing in candidates:
        q = qualityScore(listing, config.qualityByType)
        f = freshnessScore(listing, config.freshnessByType)
        e = exposureScore(listing, recentQualifiedImpressions(listing))
        listing.score = wQ*q + wF*f + wE*e

    ranked = sortDescending(candidates, score)
    ranked = exclude(ranked, session.shownListingIds)

    block = []
    held = []
```

```
    for candidate in ranked:
        if len(block) == config.blockSize: break
        if passesSoftHomePlacement(candidate, block, config):
            block.append(candidate)
        else:
            held.append(candidate)

    if len(block) < config.blockSize:
        block = governedFallback(block, held, ranked, config)

    session.shownListingIds += ids(block)
    saveCursorAndReasons(session, block, config.version)
    return block
```

19. MVP configuration sheet

Parameter	Starting recommendation	Hard-coded?
blockSize	20 where supply permits	No
formalExplorationSlots	0 for 0–199	No
personalisation	Off	Feature flag
paidRanking	Off	Feature flag
qualityWeight	40–50% depending MVP sub-stage	No
freshnessWeight	30–45% depending MVP sub-stage	No
exposureWeight	15–20%	No
sellerCapFirst20	2 soft; relax to 3/4 through fallback	No
maxSameTypeRun	4 soft	No
maxSameSubcategoryRun	3 soft	No
freshnessResetCooldown	72h starting point	No
impressionRule	Example ≥50% visible ≥1 s	No
sessionExpiry	Product decision; test 4–24h	No
qualityFloor	Type-specific; raise when inventory permits	No
extraListingAllowance	Commercial parameter	No

20. When the MVP graduates beyond 199

Move to the 200+ Discovery strategy only when the marketplace shows depth, not simply when ID number 200 is created.

- At least 200 eligible active unique listings overall.
- Enough distinct sellers that Home diversity does not constantly invoke fallback.
- At least one listing type has enough depth for multiple blocks; type-specific mixing should activate only for lanes with depth.
- Exposure data shows that qualified listings are beginning to receive materially unequal visibility.
- Impression and outcome events are reliable enough to measure a 1-per-20 Exploration experiment.
- Buyer traffic is sufficient before testing paid visibility.

Graduation rule

At 200–499, introduce up to one formal Exploration card per 20 and, only where lane depth supports it, start moving Home toward the soft 60/25/15 prior. The 0–199 rules remain the fallback whenever a location, category or lane behaves like a thin marketplace.

21. Final operating rule

Developer summary

For Midora with 0–199 eligible listings: never fake abundance; filter first; score by quality, freshness and fair exposure; circulate unseen unique cards before recycling; use soft seller/type/subcategory anti-clumping instead of fixed type quotas; preserve hard trust/availability rules through fallback; let Search, Categories and Filters obey intent; give Premium Shops more capacity and tools but no hidden organic advantage; monetised extra listings buy publishing capacity, not ranking; collect clean data now so formal Exploration and paid distribution can be introduced safely after the marketplace develops real depth.

22. Location & Buyer State for the 0–199 MVP

Why this section exists

Location must help a buyer find usable inventory without making a small marketplace appear empty. Guest and logged-in buyers should both be allowed to browse freely. Login should add memory and convenience, not unlock the basic marketplace. This section explains the full logic in plain language for Midora and the developer.

22.1 Senior 4 explanation: the market and the taxi stages

Imagine a buyer is at a market in Kampala looking for a phone, a plumber or a job. A phone may be delivered from Wakiso. A plumber must normally serve Kampala. A remote job may be useful from anywhere in Uganda. Therefore, Midora cannot treat location in the same way for Products, Services and Opportunities.

Simple memory rule

Products use item location plus delivery. Services use service area, not merely business address. Opportunities use work location plus remote, hybrid and relocation options.

22.2 Location data required by listing type

Listing type	Required location fields	Why
Product	itemLocation; pickupAvailable; deliveryAreas; nationwideDelivery; deliveryFee or delivery note	A distant Product may still be relevant when delivery is possible.
Service	businessBase; serviceAreas; travelsToCustomer; maximumTravelDistance; remoteServiceAvailable	The seller's address does not prove where the Service is offered.
Opportunity	workLocation; remoteStatus; hybridStatus; relocationSupported; applicationLocationRestrictions	A remote Opportunity can be nationally relevant; an on-site role cannot.
Shop	businessBase; branches; delivery/service coverage	Shop location must not automatically become every listing's exact service/location coverage.

Data warning

Do not store only "location = Kampala". That single field cannot distinguish item pickup, delivery coverage, service coverage, remote work, branches or relocation.

22.3 Buyer location hierarchy

```
Use location in this order:
1. Location written in the current Search query
2. Location selected in current Filters
3. Location explicitly selected for this browsing session
4. Logged-in buyer default location
5. Broad marketplace default, such as All Uganda

A stronger explicit choice always overrides a weaker remembered choice.
```

Example: A logged-in buyer normally browses Kampala but searches "jobs in Entebbe". Midora must respect Entebbe for that search. The saved Kampala preference must not silently pull results back to Kampala.

22.4 Guest buyer experience

Guest principle

Allow a Guest to discover value before demanding registration. A new marketplace should not place an account wall between the buyer and thin inventory.

Guest capability	MVP behaviour
Open Home	Allowed.
Select location	Allowed; stored in the browser/session.
Use current location	Optional button after explanation; never force precise GPS immediately.
Search	Allowed.
Categories and Filters	Allowed.
Open listing and Shop	Allowed.
Contact seller	Preferably allowed, subject to anti-abuse controls.
Share listing	Allowed.
Save listing	Ask Guest to create/sign in to an account because persistence is required.
Save Search / create alert	Ask for sign-in.
Follow Shop	Ask for sign-in.
Persistent location across devices	Requires sign-in.
Personalised feed	Not used in 0–199 MVP.

22.5 How Midora asks a Guest for location

- Do not ask for an account first.
- Show a simple prompt: “Where would you like to browse?”
- Offer practical choices such as Kampala, Wakiso, Mukono, Entebbe, Other location and All Uganda, based on areas Midora actually supports.
- Provide “Use my current location” as an optional action, not an automatic browser permission request.
- Show the active browsing area on Home, for example “Near Kampala ▾”, and make it easy to change.
- Remember the choice only for the Guest session or browser storage and explain that signing in can save it permanently.

Privacy caution

Do not require precise GPS coordinates for normal browsing. A town, district, municipality or selected service area is usually enough for the MVP. Ask for precise location only when a feature genuinely needs it and explain the benefit.

22.6 Logged-in buyer experience

At MVP, login should mainly provide persistent convenience. Midora does not yet have enough inventory or behavioural data for aggressive personalisation.

Logged-in capability	MVP behaviour
Default browsing location	Saved and editable.
Saved listings	Available across sessions/devices.
Saved Searches	Available.
Location-based alerts	Available, for example “New housemaid listings serving Wakiso”.
Follow Shops	Available.
Recently viewed	Optional and privacy-controlled.
Category preferences	May be stored, but should not heavily reshape Home before 200 listings.
Home ranking	Uses the same core quality, freshness, exposure and location logic as Guest Home.
Personalisation	Off or extremely light; do not create a separate tiny inventory bubble.

Important distinction

Guest versus logged in is a state-management difference at MVP, not a quality-ranking privilege. A logged-in buyer should not receive “better” inventory; the account mainly remembers choices and enables saving, alerts and following.

22.7 Location behaviour by inventory stage

Eligible inventory	How strongly location affects Home	Fallback

0	Location captures demand only. Ask what the buyer wants and where.	Offer notify-me, request and seller-recommendation actions.
1–49	Display location and delivery/service coverage. Apply little or no ranking penalty for distance.	Show qualified wider-area inventory with clear labels.
50–99	Use light preference when two candidates are otherwise similar.	Local → nearby → wider Uganda.
100–199	Use configured LocationFit as a material but not dominant score component by listing type.	Expand geography before returning an empty feed.
Search/Filters at any size	Explicit location is a hard or strong intent depending on the selected control.	Broaden only with the buyer's clear permission.

22.8 Geographic rings and Home fallback

```
Ring 1: LOCAL
Buyer-selected town/district and listing serves/delivers there

Ring 2: NEARBY
Configured neighbouring areas OR seller explicitly serves/delivers there

Ring 3: WIDER UGANDA
Nationwide delivery, remote service/opportunity, relocation support, or general national inventory

Build order:
Quality-passing Local candidates
  ↓ insufficient
Quality-passing Nearby candidates
  ↓ insufficient
Quality-passing Wider Uganda candidates
```

Do not hide expansion

When a result is outside the selected area, show why it is still relevant, for example "Delivers to Kampala", "Serves Wakiso", "Remote opportunity", or "Relocation supported".

22.9 LocationFit calculations

LocationFit should be calculated differently for each listing type and stored as configurable rules. The numbers below are reasonable starting points for testing, not permanent truths.

Product situation	LocationFit
Same selected area	100
Nearby area	80
Further away but delivers to selected area	75
Nationwide delivery	70
Further away, pickup only	25
No usable location/delivery information	0–20 or quality failure

Service situation	LocationFit
Selected area explicitly included in serviceAreas	100
Nearby and travels to selected area	80
Remote Service available and suitable	90
Seller may travel but coverage unclear	40
Outside service area	0

Opportunity situation	LocationFit
Remote and buyer is eligible	100
Work location matches selected area	100
Nearby work location	80
Different region with relocation supported	60

Different region, on-site, no relocation	20
Location restriction makes buyer ineligible	0

22.10 Adding LocationFit to the Home score

```
For 1–49 listings:
HomeScore ≈ Quality + Freshness + Exposure
Location mostly informs the card and fallback.

For 50–99 listings, example:
45% Quality + 35% Freshness + 15% Exposure + 5% LocationFit

For 100–199 listings, example Product Home:
45% Quality + 25% Freshness + 15% Exposure + 15% LocationFit

Example Service Home:
40% Quality + 20% Freshness + 15% Exposure + 25% ServiceAreaFit

All weights are configurable by listing type and MVP sub-stage.
```

22.11 Worked calculation

Signal	Local Product A	Distant deliverable Product B
Quality	90	96
Freshness	70	75
Exposure	60	80
LocationFit	100	40

```
Product A = .45(90) + .25(70) + .15(60) + .15(100)
          = 40.5 + 17.5 + 9 + 15 = 82.0

Product B = .45(96) + .25(75) + .15(80) + .15(40)
          = 43.2 + 18.75 + 12 + 6 = 79.95
```

Product A wins narrowly because the local match is useful. Product B remains competitive because quality is excellent. Location helps a good local card; it does not automatically rescue a poor local card.

22.12 Search, Categories and Filters

Surface	Location rule
Home	Use selected/saved area as a preference, then expand rings when inventory is thin.
Search query with place	The query place wins. “Toyota Premio Mbarara” uses Mbarara.
Location Filter	Treat as a hard constraint until the buyer chooses to broaden it.
Category	Use location appropriate to the category and listing type.
Shop	Show Shop inventory; location/delivery labels explain usability.
Zero results	Do not silently replace exact location results with another town. Ask to broaden.
Low results	Show exact results first; then clearly separate nearby/deliverable alternatives.

22.13 Empty-location and demand-capture experience

Example: a buyer searches for plumbers in Masaka and no Service covers Masaka.

- State clearly: “No plumbers serving Masaka are listed yet.”
- Offer “Show providers who may travel to Masaka” only if the seller data supports this.
- Offer a nearby-area expansion as a separate action.

- Allow the logged-in buyer to create an alert.
- Allow a Guest to enter a phone/email alert only if the privacy and consent flow is ready, otherwise request sign-in.
- Offer “Recommend a plumber in Masaka” or “Invite a provider”.
- Record a demand event: category=Plumber, location=Masaka, zeroResults=true.

Marketplace growth opportunity

Aggregated demand signals can later help Midora recruit supply: for example, “Buyers searched for plumbers in Masaka 73 times this month.” Do not expose personal search histories to sellers.

22.14 Location gaming and data quality

Risk	Control
Every seller selects Kampala for visibility	Require separate base location and actual delivery/service areas; monitor implausible coverage.
Nationwide delivery selected falsely	Require delivery method/details and use complaints/failed-contact feedback later.
Service seller selects all districts	Limit or price extensive service areas only when operationally justified; ask travel terms.
Opportunity marked Remote incorrectly	Require remote/hybrid/on-site structured field and moderation/reporting.
Buyer precise GPS stored unnecessarily	Store coarse selected area for browsing; minimise retention of precise coordinates.
Location has spelling variations	Use controlled place IDs plus display names; do not rely only on free text.
Branch and item location confused	Store Shop branches separately from listing-level item/service location.

22.15 Free seller and Premium Shop location rules

Rule	Free seller	Premium Shop
Organic LocationFit	Same formula.	Same formula.
Listing/service areas	Basic configured limit.	May receive richer multi-branch, delivery-zone and service-area management.
Location analytics	Basic or none.	May later receive aggregated demand-by-location analytics.
Local ranking bonus	No paid bonus.	No paid bonus.
Sponsored local campaign	Not in 0–199 MVP.	Not in 0–199 MVP; later must be labelled, relevant and quality-passing.
Verification	Location claim is not automatically verified.	Premium status does not verify location.

Strong future Premium feature

Demand-by-location analytics is more defensible than hidden ranking points. A Premium Shop could later see aggregated searches by area and category, while Midora protects buyer privacy.

22.16 Guest-to-account conversion moments

- Save a listing: “Create a free account to find this listing later.”
- Create an alert: “Get notified when new Products, Services or Opportunities appear in Kampala.”
- Follow a Shop: “Sign in to see new listings from this Shop.”
- Save location: “Keep Wakiso as your default area across devices.”
- Save Search: “Save ‘housemaids serving Entebbe’ and receive updates.”

Conversion principle

Ask for login when the account provides an obvious benefit. Do not block ordinary browsing merely to increase registration numbers.

22.17 Buyer-state data model

```
GuestSession {
  sessionId, selectedAreaId, selectedAreaLabel,
  shownListingIds, searchHistorySessionOnly,
  selectedCategories, selectedFilters, createdAt, expiresAt
}

BuyerProfile {
  buyerId, defaultAreaId, savedListingIds, savedSearches,
  followedShopIds, alertPreferences, notificationConsent,
  optionalRecentlyViewed, privacySettings
}

LocationContext {
  source: query | filter | session | profile | default,
  areaId, radiusOrRing, precisionLevel, selectedAt
}
```

22.18 Developer pipeline with buyer state and location

```
resolveBuyerState(request):
  if query contains explicit place: use QUERY location
  else if filters contain location: use FILTER location
  else if guest session selected area: use SESSION location
  else if logged-in profile default exists: use PROFILE location
  else: use ALL_UGANDA or ask buyer

buildHome(request):
  state = resolveBuyerState(request)
  candidates = hardEligibilityFilter(loadInventory())
  candidates = deduplicate(candidates)
  for candidate in candidates:
      quality = qualityScore(candidate)
      fresh = freshnessScore(candidate)
      exposure = exposureScore(candidate)
      locationFit = locationFitByType(candidate, state.location)
      candidate.score = weightedScore(quality, fresh, exposure, locationFit)
  local, nearby, wider = assignGeographicRings(candidates, state.location)
  ranked = rank(local) + controlledExpansion(rank(nearby), rank(wider))
  return placeWithHomeRules(ranked, session)
```

22.19 Location & Buyer State acceptance tests

- ☐ Guest can browse, Search, filter and change location without creating an account.
- ☐ Guest location persists for the configured session but does not pretend to be a verified home address.
- ☐ Logged-in buyer can save and change the default location.
- ☐ Search location overrides saved location.
- ☐ A Product outside the area but delivering there can remain relevant.
- ☐ A Service outside its declared service area receives LocationFit 0.
- ☐ A remote Opportunity is not penalised for physical distance when the buyer is eligible.
- ☐ No local inventory expands to nearby/wider inventory without duplicating cards.
- ☐ Expanded cards show why they are relevant to the selected location.
- ☐ Location Filter is not silently broken.
- ☐ Premium status does not add LocationFit or an organic local-ranking bonus.
- ☐ Precise GPS is not requested automatically on first visit.
- ☐ Zero-result location demand is recorded without exposing individual buyer data.
- ☐ Location weights can be changed by type and sub-stage without code changes.

22.20 Exact implementation rule

Developer summary

For the 0–199 MVP, let Guest and logged-in buyers browse the same qualified marketplace. Guests can select an area temporarily; logged-in buyers can save locations, listings, searches, alerts and Shops. Resolve location from explicit query or filter before remembered preferences. Treat Product delivery, Service coverage and Opportunity work mode differently. Prefer local usable inventory but expand Local → Nearby → Wider Uganda when supply is thin. Show why an expanded card is relevant. Never allow Premium status, payment or geographic closeness to override safety, quality, explicit filters or actual service/delivery eligibility.

Midora should refresh the candidate pool at controlled moments, not continuously reshuffle cards while somebody is looking at them (We need to Test this)

Think of two types of change

A. Buyer-triggered changes

These should cause an immediate rebuild or context change: (Test)

Buyer action	What Midora should do
Opens Home	Start/resume Home session
Pull-to-refresh / Refresh	Request refreshed Home block
Changes location	Rebuild using new location context (We need to Test)
Search	Build separate Search results
Selects Category	Build Category results
Applies Filter	Rebuild results using those hard constraints
Clears Filter	Rebuild broader results
Logs in	Preserve current context, then attach persistent buyer state
Logs out	Return to Guest state
Scrolls	Fetch **next block**, not rebuild current cards

B. Marketplace-triggered changes

Suppose Pauline MUNGUJAKISA is looking at Midora.
At 10:00: 120 eligible listings
At 10:03 a seller posts: iPhone 15 Pro, Kampala
10:04 another seller marks a laptop: SOLD
At 10:05 an Opportunity closes.

The buyer hasn't touched anything.
Midora's underlying inventory has still changed.
So Midora needs to handle events such as:
New listing published
Listing sold
Listing expired
Opportunity closed

Service becomes unavailable
Listing materially updated
Listing blocked/moderated
Seller suspended
Listing deleted

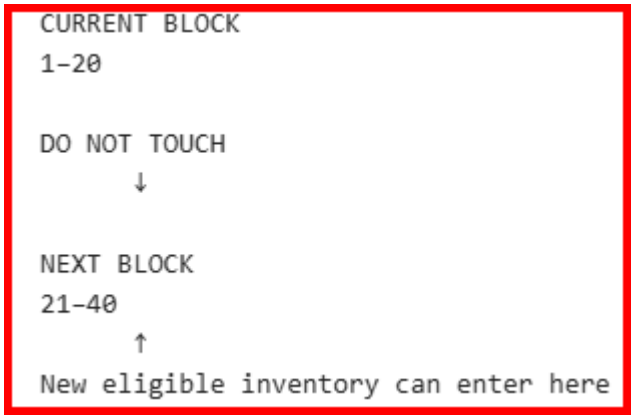
But here's the important part: Don't live-shuffle the screen!
Imagine the buyer is scrolling:
Card 1
Card 2
Card 3
Card 4
Suddenly a new Product arrives and Midora says: Great! That's now #2.

Then everything moves:
Card 1
NEW CARD
Card 2
Card 3

That's horrible UX.The user loses their place.
Don't do that.

Implement better like this:
At 10:00 the buyer opens Home.
Midora creates:
feedSessionId = ABC123
candidateSnapshotTime = 10:00

It calculates the first block:1-20
The buyer sees those cards. Meanwhile new inventory can arrive. It doesn't rearrange cards 1–20.
Buyer reaches the bottom
At 10:04 the app requests: Give me the next 20. Now Midora can check: What changed since 10:00? Suppose there are 3 greats listings? They can enter consideration for **Block 2**. So:



Three levels of freshness

I would explicitly build these.

Level 1: Current-card stability

Once a card has been delivered within the current visible block:
Don't reshuffle it.
Exception: it becomes invalid. For example:

- Product becomes SOLD
- Opportunity closes
- Listing is deleted
- Moderation blocks listing
- Then don't continue promoting it.

If already visible, the UI could update its state: **Sold**, rather than rearranging the entire feed.

Level 2: Next-block freshness

Every time Midora fetches another 20: Check:

- new listings?
- meaningful updates?
- expired inventory?
- sold inventory?
- moderation changes?

Now newly eligible candidates can compete for positions 21–40. That gives Midora freshness **without destroying scroll stability**.

Level 3: Session refresh

Eventually the entire candidate ranking becomes stale. So the session should expire.

For the MVP, I'd test something around: **4–12 hours** not hard-code it. Control in admin. After expiry:

```
New session
     ↓
Recalculate eligible inventory
     ↓
Recalculate freshness
     ↓
Recalculate exposure
     ↓
Recalculate location fit
     ↓
New ranking
```

A buyer returning tomorrow therefore gets a genuinely fresh Home.

What should Refresh do?

This needs careful treatment.

If the buyer explicitly pulls down to refresh, I'd interpret that as: "Show me what's new."

So Midora can create a **new Home ranking from current inventory**.

But don't let refresh become a loophole that allows people to repeatedly create impressions.

For example:

```
refresh
refresh
refresh
refresh
```

shouldn't give a seller four legitimate impressions from the same buyer in 20 seconds. Your qualified-impression logic should deduplicate suspicious/repeated exposure.

What Search should do?

Search does **not refresh the Home feed**.

Search starts a different discovery context.

Example:

```
Home session
ABC123

Buyer searches:
"iPhone Kampala"

          ↓

Search context
XYZ456
```

The Search results obey:

```
Query relevance
Location intent
Filters
Availability
Quality
Freshness
```

not Home's type-balancing logic.

When the buyer returns Home, I'd preserve the previous Home position during the MVP unless the Home session has expired.

Filters work similarly

Suppose Home is:

Near Kampala

The buyer chooses:

```
Services
Cleaning
Wakiso
Available today
```

Those are now explicit instructions. Midora creates:

```
Filtered context

Type     = Service
Category = Cleaning
Location = Wakiso
```

Don't try to inject Products or Opportunities because Home normally has a mixed feed.The buyer's instruction wins.

What happens when new content appears?

This is where I would add a nice lightweight feature later in the MVP.

Suppose the buyer has been scrolling for 15 minutes and five new listings arrive.

Rather than secretly reshuffling:

5 new listings ↑

The buyer taps it.

Then Midora refreshes Home.

This is similar to the familiar:

"New posts" pattern. Much better UX than teleporting content around.

New inventory should trigger backend invalidation

The developer should think about two systems.

Inventory events

```
listing.created
listing.published
listing.updated_meaningfully
listing.sold
listing.closed
listing.expired
listing.deleted
listing.blocked
seller.suspended
```

These events invalidate relevant cached candidate pools.

For example:

New plumber, Service area = Wakiso

Midora does **not** need to invalidate:

every buyer in Uganda.

It could invalidate/cache-refresh candidate pools relevant to:

```
Service
Plumbing
Wakiso
Nearby areas
```

That becomes increasingly useful as Midora grows.

For 0–199 listings, however, I would keep caching simple.

At MVP, don't over-engineer real-time feeds

Honestly, with **0–199 listings**, Midora does not need Instagram-scale infrastructure.

I'd use something like:

Honestly, with **0–199 listings**, Midora does not need Instagram-scale infrastructure.

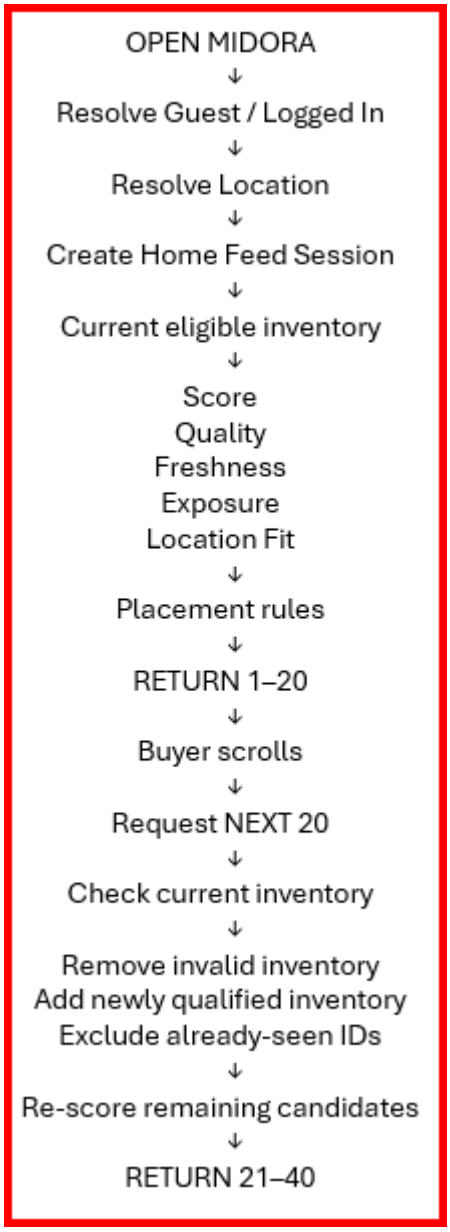
I'd use something like:

```
Inventory DB
      ↓
On Home request
      ↓
Fetch current eligible inventory
      ↓
Score candidates
      ↓
Exclude session-seen
      ↓
Build 20
```

At fewer than 200 listings this computation is tiny. Don't prematurely build Kafka-style streaming infrastructure just because sophisticated feeds use it.

Suggested MVP feed lifecycle

That's much cleaner than freezing the entire marketplace when Home opens.



What could cause immediate disappearance?

- **This matters.**

Immediately invalidate

These should stop being returned immediately:

- Deleted listing

- Blocked listing
- Suspended seller
- Sold Product
- Closed Opportunity
- Expired Opportunity
- Service marked unavailable, depending on how availability is defined

Can wait until normal next-block refresh

These can normally enter later:

- Newly created listing
- Price improvement
- New photograph
- Meaningful description update
- Service coverage expansion
- Opportunity deadline extension

That distinction prevents excessive feed instability.

Logged-in buyer has one advantage here

Because Midora knows the buyer across sessions, Midora can maintain: recentlyShownListingIds for longer. So if a logged-in buyer comes back three hours later: Don't show exactly the same first 20 again unless inventory is genuinely tiny.

For Guests, you can do something similar using the temporary browser/session ID, but eventually that history disappears.

I would distinguish three clocks

This will make the developer's implementation much clearer.

1. Listing clock

Controls:How fresh is this listing?

Driven by:

publishedAt

meaningfulUpdatedAt

---

2. Feed-session clock

Controls: When should this user's candidate ranking be rebuilt?

Maybe:

4–12 hours initially, configurable.

---

3. Impression clock

Controls: When does another exposure count again?

Example:

The same buyer viewing the same listing ten times within five minutes should not create ten meaningful impressions.

This requires its own deduplication window.

Don't use one timestamp for all three things.

Final rule for Midora

The Home feed should update from three sources:

Buyer events

Refresh, scrolling, location change, returning Home.

Marketplace events

New listings, meaningful updates, sold/closed inventory, expiry, moderation.

Time events

Freshness decay, feed-session expiry and impression-deduplication windows.

So the real model is:

Plain Text

```
BUYER EVENTS
      +
MARKETPLACE EVENTS
      +
TIME
      ↓
FEED ENGINE
```

For Midora's 0–199 MVP, I would reconsider the candidate pool at every next-block request and explicit refresh, while keeping cards the buyer has already seen stable. That gives you a feed that feels alive without making it jump around unpredictably.

One more distinction: Feed refresh vs data refresh

Developers sometimes combine these.
They shouldn't.

Data refresh
The system knows:
Product X was sold.
That should update immediately.

Feed refresh
The system asks:
Where should every remaining listing now rank?
That does not have to happen every second.
So:
Inventory truth should update quickly. Ranking order can update at controlled boundaries.
That's the architecture I'd adopt.